lacked strategic depth, making them vulnerable to deep penetration by Indian armor and mechanized infantry. And the Pakistan Army suffered from a severe shortage of officers, forcing it to rely heavily on British personnel.[65] Thus the Pakistani state began life facing severe military challenges. This contributed to an overriding focus on national security among Pakistani elites, which in turn promoted both the rise of Islamism and the ascendancy of the army in Pakistani politics.[66]

Since independence, Pakistan's security situation has of course improved. Nonetheless, Pakistan remains significantly weaker than India. For example, in 2008, India enjoyed a roughly 2:1 advantage in active duty personnel, and a 1.6:1 advantage in combat-capable aircraft and main battle tanks. India's defense budget was more than five times that of Pakistan.[67] And Pakistan continues to suffer from a lack of strategic depth. Augmented Indian military capabilities will, therefore, put further pressure on an already vulnerable Pakistan.

Traditionally, Pakistan's military weakness vis-à-vis India was mitigated by India's peacetime deployment of offensive forces deep in the interior of the country, far from the Indo-Pakistani border. As a result of this positioning, Indian forces were slow to mobilize against the Pakistanis, requiring several weeks before launching a large-scale offensive.[68] This gave Pakistan time to prepare its defenses and ward off any impending Indian attack. It also allowed the international community to bring diplomatic pressure to bear on India's civilian leadership, thereby preventing it from launching military action.

Many Indian military leaders believe that this mobilization problem prevented India from acting decisively during the 2001–2002 crisis. By the time Indian forces were prepared to move against Pakistan, the Pakistanis were able to ready their defenses, thereby making a potential Indian attack far more costly. Most importantly, the Indians' slowness enabled the United States to pressure the Indian government, convincing it to abandon plans to strike Pakistan. Thus, in the words of Sandeep Unnithan, Parakram demonstrated that India's "mobilization strategy was completely flawed."[69] In addition, the government's restraint caused rancor within the armed forces. Senior officers believed that civilian leaders misused the military,